INDEX NUMBER_____ SIGNATURE_____

UNIVERSITY OF GHANA

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DEPARTMENT OF TEACHER EDUCATION

SCHOOL OF EDUCATION AND LEADERSHIP

COLLEGES OF EDUCATION

END OF SEMESTER ONE EXAMINATIONS FOR LEVEL 200, 2024/2025

B.ED. PROGRAMME

COURSE CODE: TEJS 213

COURSE TITLE: English Semantics

Instruction: Answer **all** questions in Section A and any **three** questions in Section B.

Time: 2 hours

SECTION A

[25 Marks]

Answer **all** the questions in this section.

1. Which of the following best describes the fundamental concept of semantics?
   A. Analysis of grammatical structures
   B. Study of meaning in language
   C. Study of sentence patterns
   D. Study of word formation

INDEX NUMBER_____ SIGNATURE_____

2. The term 'lexical semantics' refers to _____.
   A. Grammar rules in a language
   B. Meaning relationships between sentences
   C. Study of word meanings
   D. Word order in sentences

3. What is the primary focus of conceptual meaning in semantics?
   A. Cultural associations of words
   B. Emotional aspects of meaning
   C. Logical content of words
   D. Social context of language use

4. Connotative meaning primarily deals with_____.
   A. Associative meanings of words
   B. Dictionary definitions
   C. Grammatical structures
   D. Literal word meanings

5. Which type of meaning is most concerned with social context and relationships?
   A. Affective meaning
   B. Conceptual meaning
   C. Social meaning
   D. Thematic meaning

6. The semantic relationship between 'hot' and 'cold' is an example of:
   A. Homonymy
   B. Hyponymy
   C. Polysemy
   D. Antonymy

7. In semantic analysis, synonymy refers to_____.
   A. Different meanings of the same word
   B. Opposite meanings
   C. Similar or identical meanings
   D. Words with multiple related meanings

8. Which sense relation involves a word being included within the meaning of another word
   A. Antonymy
   B. Homonymy
   C. Hyponymy
   D. Synonymy

INDEX NUMBER_____ SIGNATURE_____

9. In English sentences, what determines the semantic role of agent?
   A. Object position
   B. Subject position and active voice
   C. Verb tense
   D. Word order only

10. Which of the following sentences contains a tautology?
   A. War is war.
   B. War is terrible.
   C. War is costly.
   D. War is destructive.

11. What is the primary function of case roles in semantic analysis?
   A. Determining sentence structure roles
   B. Identifying grammatical patterns and roles
   C. Showing relationships between words and their roles
   D. Specifying participant roles

12. Semantic anomaly in English sentences occurs when_____
   A. grammar rules are broken.
   B. meaning restrictions are violated.
   C. punctuation is incorrect.
   D. words are misspelled.

13. Which semantic relation exists between the words 'furniture' and 'chair'?
   A. Antonymy
   B. Homonymy
   C. Hyponymy
   D. Synonymy

14. In teaching second language vocabulary, which of the underlisted approaches is most effective for concrete nouns?
   A. Abstract explanations
   B. Direct translation
   C. Visual representation
   D. Word association

INDEX NUMBER_____ SIGNATURE_____

15. Which of the following statements is entailed by 'The cat ate the mouse'?
    A. The mouse was eaten
    B. The cat was hungry
    C. The mouse died instantly
    D. The cat enjoys eating mice

16. What is the best strategy for teaching abstract concepts in a second language?
    A. Contextual examples
    B. Direct translation only
    C. Memorization drills
    D. Word-for-word definitions

17. Which of the following methods is most effective for teaching polysemous words?
    A. Dictionary definitions only
    B. Multiple context examples
    C. Single context presentation
    D. Word lists

18. In teaching word meaning, what is the primary advantage of componential analysis?
    A. Easier pronunciation practice
    B. Grammar rule learning
    C. Systematic meaning comparison
    D. Vocabulary memorisation

19. In componential analysis, how are semantic components typically expressed?
    A. As numerical values
    B. As binary features (+/-)
    C. As pictorial representations
    D. As word associations

20. What is a referent in denotative meaning?
    A. A dictionary definition
    B. A mental image
    C. The actual object being referred to
    D. The word itself

21. What type of ambiguity is present in "Flying planes can be dangerous"?
    A. Lexical ambiguity
    B. Structural ambiguity
    C. Referential ambiguity
    D. Scope ambiguity

INDEX NUMBER_____ SIGNATURE_____

22. In componential analysis, which of the underlisted feature combinations correctly represents "woman"?

A. [+human] [-male] [-adult]

B. [+human] [+male] [+adult]

C. [+human] [-male] [+adult]

D. [-human] [-male] [+adult]

23. Which of the following pair of words represents formal versus informal usage?

A. Liberty - freedom

B. Purchase - buy

C. Petrol - gasoline

D. Male – female

24. Considering the old vrs new meanings of the word lady, what kind of semantic change has the word undergone.

Old meaning: (lady) – "loaf-kneader"

New meaning: (lady) –"a refined, polite woman" or "a woman of high social position"

A. Pejoration
B. Amelioration
C. Extension
D. Narrowing

25. Identify the semantic role of the underlined argument.
'<u>The heavy storm</u> vandalised most buildings in the village.'
A. Agent
B. Theme
C. External causer
D. Instrument

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INDEX NUMBER_____

SECTION B

[75 Marks]

Answer any **three** questions in this section.

1. a) What is semantics? [5 Marks]

   b) Discuss the relationship between semantics and pragmatics in language use. [10 Marks]

   c) In which three (3) ways can knowledge of semantics improve second language teaching and learning? [10 Marks]

2. a) Mention three (3) major difficulties in teaching meaning to second language learners. [3 Marks]

   b) With three (3) examples, discuss the role of context in meaning interpretation. [10 Marks]

   c) Explain four (4) effective methods you would employ in teaching meaning in second language classrooms. [12 Marks]

3. a) With two (2) examples for each, differentiate between denotative and connotative meanings. [10 Marks]

   b) Discuss three (3) ways by which teachers' knowledge of the different types of meaning can contribute to effective language instruction. [10 marks]

   c) Explain the difference between social meaning and affective meaning. [5 Marks]

4. a) What are sense relations? [5 Marks]

   b) With two (2) examples for each, differentiate between polysemy and homonymy. [10 Marks]

INDEX NUMBER_____ SIGNATURE_____

c) Explain three (3) ways by which teachers can use sense relations to enhance students' vocabulary acquisition. [10 Marks]

5. a) What is ambiguity in language use? [5 Marks]

b) Discuss three (3) ways by which teachers can support students to recognise and resolve ambiguities in communication. [10 Mark]

c) With two (2) examples for each, differentiate between argument structure and thematic roles. [10 Marks]